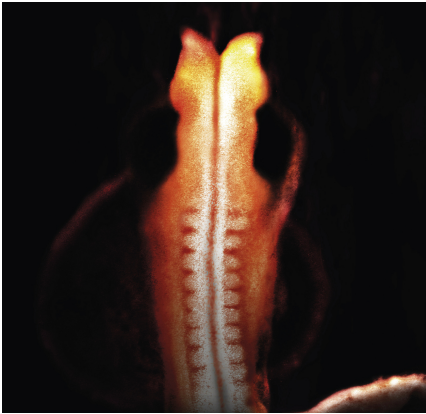




YOU ARE **5 WEEKS AND 1 DAY**

244 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The embryo now has 14 somites—the building blocks of your baby’s muscular system. The first nine pairs are shown here. The upper part of the image shows the head end of the neural tube, which has now nearly closed.

“If you’ve had no symptoms as you enter your 6th week, you may be on the lookout for signs that you are in fact pregnant.”

You and your partner are probably the only people who know you’re pregnant, and you may still be wondering if it’s real. At this stage you may not have any symptoms at all, despite the rapidly changing and growing embryo inside you. This absence of pregnancy signs is completely normal and is not a cause for concern. Try to remember that the majority of pregnancies are without any complications. It’s normal for a healthy pregnant woman to have a wide range of side effects or none at all. So don’t worry if you’re feeling great—in fact count yourself lucky!

EARLY ULTRASOUND SCANS

Some women will have an early ultrasound scan, but the majority of women will have one around the 12th week of pregnancy (see [First ultrasound scan](#)). Early scans are usually done vaginally, with a scanning probe inserted gently into the vagina. They are performed for the following reasons:

- **If there is a history of multiple births** in your family (or you have used IVF or another form of assisted pregnancy), your doctor may want to check the number of fetuses.
- **If you’ve had a miscarriage in the past**, or show signs of cramping or spotting, or more profuse bleeding, a scan can be done to check that there is still a heartbeat.
- **To establish the cause of vaginal bleeding.** Your baby may be healthy, but fibroids or other conditions may be causing you to bleed. This will be addressed by your doctor.